dedication to his work was exemplary. He would bring X-ray payloads from ISAS, which along with the X-ray payloads made by Prof. UR Rao, would be engineered by my team to fit into the nose cone of the Rohini Rocket. At an altitude of 150 km, the nose cone would be separated by explosion of pyros triggered by an electronic timer. With this, the X-ray sensors would be exposed to space for col ecting the required information about the emissions from stars. Together, Prof. Oda and Prof. Rao were a unique blend of intel ect and dedication, which one rarely sees. One day, when I was working on the integration for Prof. Oda's payload with my timer devices, he insisted on using the timers he had brought from Japan. To me they looked flimsy, but Prof. Oda stuck to his stand that the Indian timers be replaced by the Japanese ones. I yielded to his suggestion and replaced the timers. The rocket took off elegantly and attained the intended altitude. But the telemetry signal reported mission failure on account of timer malfunction. Prof. Oda was so upset that tears wel ed up in his eyes. I was stunned by the emotional intensity of Prof. Oda's response. He had clearly put his heart and soul into his work.